BUSINESS REQUIREMENTS DOCUMENT (BRD)

Project C: Dee Bank SME Merchant Onboarding & Settlement Visibility project

Document Version: 1.0

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Target Organization: Dee Bank (Corporate & SME Banking Division)

Delivery Framework: Hybrid (Agile/Adaptive delivery with upfront requirements governance)

Document Control

Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Changes
0.1	October 2026	Ebudola Adegoke	Initial draft consolidating Tasks 1–4 (Root cause, 5-Whys, Gap Analysis, Role-play elicitation).
1.0	October 2026	Ebudola Adegoke	Baseline BRD integrating elicitation logs, business rules, MoSCoW priorities, and NFRs.

1. Executive Summary

Dee Bank's merchant onboarding and settlement communication processes are fragmented and manual. Applications arrive through multiple channels with no standard upfront checklist, onboarding team use disconnected spreadsheets, and settlement schedules and cut off rules exist internally but are never published. Merchants and customer support teams repeatedly seek the same information, causing delays, confusion, and reduced trust. This BRD defines the business requirements to implement a unified, transparent process with standardized intake, shared status visibility, merchant self-service dashboard, and published settlement timelines. The recommended approach is phased as quick process improvements first, followed by the merchant dashboard and automation. Success will be measured by reduced onboarding time, fewer repeated enquiries, and improved merchant satisfaction.

2. Business Context

2.1 Problem Statement

Merchant onboarding at Dee Bank lacks a standardized process. Applications are received via form, email, and chat with no upfront document checklist, so document submissions are frequently incomplete. Status is tracked across disconnected tools, leading to conflicting answers. Settlement cut-offs, fund processing schedules, and timelines are not communicated publicly, leaving merchants uncertain and anxious about when their funds will be processed into their accounts. Support teams are overwhelmed by repeated status and settlement enquiries, internal teams use inconsistent terminologies (same key

words have different meaning to different teams) and the manual model does not scale as merchant numbers grow.

2.2 Current State AS-IS Overview

- Merchants apply through multiple channels (phone calls, forms email, chat with no single entry point).
- No document checklist is provided to merchants initially, incomplete documentations delay this process and onboarding is placed on pending until merchants provide on further request.
- Status updates are held in individual spreadsheets with no shared real-time update.
- Settlement rules are known internally within Finance department but not documented or published publicly creating knowledge gap within the customer support team.
- No automated notification or self-service facility exists. Hence causes multiple enquiries from merchants.

2.3 Pain Points

Table

Table	Label
There are avoidable delays due to incomplete applications/incomplete documents	Confirmed
Merchants do not trust the system due to disconnected tracking tools and conflicting status information.	Confirmed

Customer support team are overwhelmed with multiple enquiries from Merchants who cannot access transactions online real time	Confirmed
Inconsistent settlement schedule causing Merchant cash flow anxiety	Confirmed
Inconsistent status terminology across Dee Bank and knowledge gap amongst customer facing staff	Confirmed
Increasing service gaps due to manual, unstandardized onboarding and fund settlement process	Proposed

2.4 Business Need

Dee Bank requires a streamlined, transparent, and scalable merchant onboarding and settlement visibility process that:

- Provides clear, consistent information requirements at the start of the journey.
- Establishes one shared source of truth for status across all teams.
- Enables merchants to check progress and settlement timelines independently.
- Publishes settlement schedules approved by Finance and Compliance department.
- Reduces repetitive enquiries so teams can focus on value adding work

3. Business Objectives & Success Measures

3.1 SMART Objectives

Table

ID	Objective	Label
OBJ-01	Reduce average merchant onboarding completion time by 40% within 3months of full launch	Proposed baseline data to be communicated
OBJ-02	Reduce status- and settlement related enquiries by 50% within 6 weeks of merchant dashboard launch	Proposed baseline volume to be communicated
OBJ-03	Achieve 90% positive merchant satisfaction rating regarding process clarity and transparency within 2 months of launch	Proposed survey mechanism to be communicated
OBJ-04	Ensure 100% of all publicly visible settlement information is reviewed and approved by Compliance before release	Confirmed mandatory requirement to be communicated

3.2 Success Measures

Table

Measure	Target	Status
Average application processing duration	–40% from baseline	Awaiting Validation
Daily repeat enquiry volume	–50% from baseline	Awaiting Validation
Merchant satisfaction score	≥ 90% positive	Proposed

Compliance approval turnaround	≤ 3 working days per batch	Proposed

4. Scope

In Scope

- Standardized merchant application intake with pre-submission document checklist and estimated timeline.
- Centralized status tracking system with standardized status glossary.
- Merchant self-service dashboard showing application progress and settlement timelines.
- Automated email/SMS notifications at key process stages.
- Public settlement schedule page showing cut-off times, processing days, and weekend/holiday rules for fund settlement.
- Internal adoption plans including team training and unified status terminology across board.
- Performance tracking system, monitoring enquiry volume, onboarding duration, dashboard adoption rate

Out of Scope

- Full core banking system replacement
- Changes to credit risk assessment or underwriting criteria
- Native mobile app development (responsive web dashboard only)
- Third-party payment gateway integration
- Redesign of Finance reconciliation internal processes.

5. Stakeholders

Table

Stakeholder Group	**Key Needs**	**Interest Level**	**Status**
SME Merchants	Clear process, predictable timelines, honest updates, self-service access	High (primary beneficiaries)	Confirmed
Customer Support	Single source of truth, consistent answers, fewer repeated enquiries	High (daily experience owners)	Confirmed
Onboarding Operations	Standard intake, no re-typing, clear bottleneck visibility	High (process owners)	Confirmed
Finance & Reconciliation	Accurate published schedules, controlled disclosure, data integrity	High (settlement authority)	Awaiting Validation, schedule draft pending
Compliance / Risk	Regulatory adherence, secure data, audit trail, pre-publication approval	High (approval authority)	Confirmed
IT / Engineering	Phased delivery, legacy compatibility, secure	Medium (build team)	Proposed

	integration		
Senior Management	Measurable improvement, scalable foundation, demonstrable ROI	High (project Sponsors) Confirmed	Confirmed

6. Business Requirements

Table

ID	Business Requirement	Description	Source / Owner	Label
BR-001	Unified Application Entry Point	One standard online form as primary intake, captures all required data in single submission	Onboarding Operations Team	Proposed
BR-002	Upfront Transparency	Full document checklist, eligibility criteria, and estimated timeline displayed before application begins	Support and Merchants	Awaiting Validation, checklist items pending
BR-003	Single Source of Truth	One central system holds all application status data, all	Operations and Customer	Proposed

		authorised teams access and update the same record	Support Team	
BR-004	Standard Status Glossary	Agreed, documented status definitions used consistently internally and externally	Business Analyst and All Teams	Awaiting Validation, definitions draft pending
BR-005	Merchant Self-Service Dashboard	Secure portal showing current stage, next action, estimated completion, settlement timeline	Merchants and Customer Support Team	Proposed
BR-006	Automated Notifications	Email/SMS alerts sent at key milestones like submission confirmations, documentation review, approvals, Successful Onboarding, settlement initiated	Customer Support Team and Merchants	Proposed, channels to be communicated

		and fund settlement completed		
BR-007	Published Settlement Schedule	Public page showing cut-off day/time, processing duration, weekend/holiday deferral rules	Finance team and Merchants	Awaiting Validation, Finance to finalize
BR-008	Controlled Disclosure Framework	Written rules defining public versus private settlement data, all public content to be approved by Compliance before release	Compliance and Finance Team	Awaiting Validation, rules draft pending
BR-009	Support Efficiency & Consistency	Support portal mirrors merchant dashboard plus internal notes and audit log, same data for all authorised users	Customer Support Team	Proposed
BR-010	Performance Reporting	Track enquiry volume by category,	Business Analyst and	Proposed, format to be

		average stage duration, dashboard adoption rate and send monthly reports to management	Senior Management	communicated

7. Solution Options & Recommended Direction

Table

Option	**Description**	**Assessment**
Option 1: Process Fixes Only	Publish checklist, agree status terms, and encourage team training	Fast implementation but limited long-term value. This is not Recommended alone
Option 2: Full Tech Build	Build portal and activate automation immediately	Complete solution but delivery takes longer time. This is not recommended alone.
Option 3: Hybrid Approach *(Recommended)*	Phase 1 (Weeks 1–2): Checklist, standard status terms, shared tracking board, settlement schedule draft Phase 2 (Months 1–3):	Delivers early wins while building long-term capability and proposed approval pending

	Merchant dashboard and automated notifications Phase 3 (Months 3–6): Full settlement visibility and deeper system integration	

8. Assumptions, Constraints, Risks & Open Questions

8.1 Assumptions

Table

Assumption	**Label**
Merchants will adopt the dashboard once available rather than continuing to email support	Proposed, adoption plan to be communicated
Existing Finance systems can share settlement timeline data via scheduled export or API	Awaiting Validation from IT team to confirm
Compliance will approve estimated settlement dates for public display	Awaiting Validation. Meeting scheduled
Document requirements are consistent across all SME merchant types	Proposed, Operations to confirm

8.2 Constraints

Table

Constraint	**Label**
Compliance approval required before any public release of settlement information	Confirmed

Budget allocated in phases; full funding subject to Phase 1 success review	Proposed
Legacy system compatibility limits real-time data synchronisation initially	Proposed
Implementation must not disrupt daily operations	Confirmed

8.3 Risks

Table

Risk	Impact	Mitigation	Label
Merchants continue contacting support instead of using portal	High adoption gap	Onboarding guide, prompt emails and personal invite	Proposed
Internal disagreement over status definitions	Confusion persists	Facilitated workshop and formal sign-off	Proposed
System integration delays push back timeline	Late full delivery	Phase 1 process fixes proceed independently	Mitigated
Sensitive data inadvertently exposed	Regulatory breach	Role-based permissions and compliance pre-release check	Proposed

8.4 Open Questions

Table

Question	Owner	Status
Can settlement dates be auto-calculated or	Finance / IT	Awaiting

require manual approval?		Validation
Are there merchant categories with different document requirements?	Onboarding Ops	Awaiting Validation
What is the official SLA for manual review stages?	Senior Management	Proposed
Which channels should be phased out once the portal is live?	Support / Management	Proposed

9.0 Sign-off & Approvals

Role	Stakeholder Name	Title	Status	Date
Project Sponsor	Senior Management	Head of SME & Corporate Banking	Pending Review	
Compliance Lead	Compliance Team	Chief Compliance & Risk Officer	Pending Review	
Finance Lead	Finance & Reconciliation Team	Head of Treasury, Reconciliation & Settlements	Pending Review	

Role	Stakeholder Name	Title	Status	Date
Product Manager	Product Onboarding Team	Head of Merchant Onboarding Operations	Pending Review	
Customer Support Lead	Customer Support Team	Head of Merchant Customer Care	Pending Review	
IT Lead	IT & Engineering	Lead Software Architect	Pending Review	